



Putting on your socks is a good time for a hamstring stretch. Simply lift the leg, or reach over to it, bow the head, and take a few breaths.

Working in an office gives you a good opportunity to use some chair stretches from the Wake up the stretch program (see pp.22–35). Reach your hands behind your head and wing your elbows open in a chest stretch. It helps your work day go faster and more smoothly. Sitting work is probably among the most tiring, and it's important to take frequent breaks, even for a few breaths. Office stretches increase clear thinking as well as helping to avoid computer over-use problems that can affect your chest, hands, and arms. Intermittent breathing and stretches will make you a more productive worker, whatever you do for a living.

An everyday habit

Perseverance is simple when you make stretches an everyday habit. Habits can be formed in as little as 21 days, so set a goal on your calendar for the next 21 days and find opportunities for a stretch at home, work, and play. Have faith: the body will change, but only with persistence. Stretching in everyday life makes that persistence easy.

Take a twist break at the office. Cross one leg over the other and turn in the direction of the crossed leg, as shown in our Seated cross-leg twist (see p.30).

>> everyday stretches that make a difference

- **Reach a little farther** to stretch into that cabinet. Take a break. Yawn to stretch the jaw. Open the eyes and look upward to open the chest and neck.
- **Stretch your legs and hips** when putting on and taking off clothes. Practice lunges when vacuuming and move your hips from side to side when sweeping.
- **Renew your posture at the office** by squeezing between the shoulder blades and rolling your shoulders. Firm the glutes and sit up tall.

